22 · OTTICA 16

quiet mastery for mechanical optics · Roma

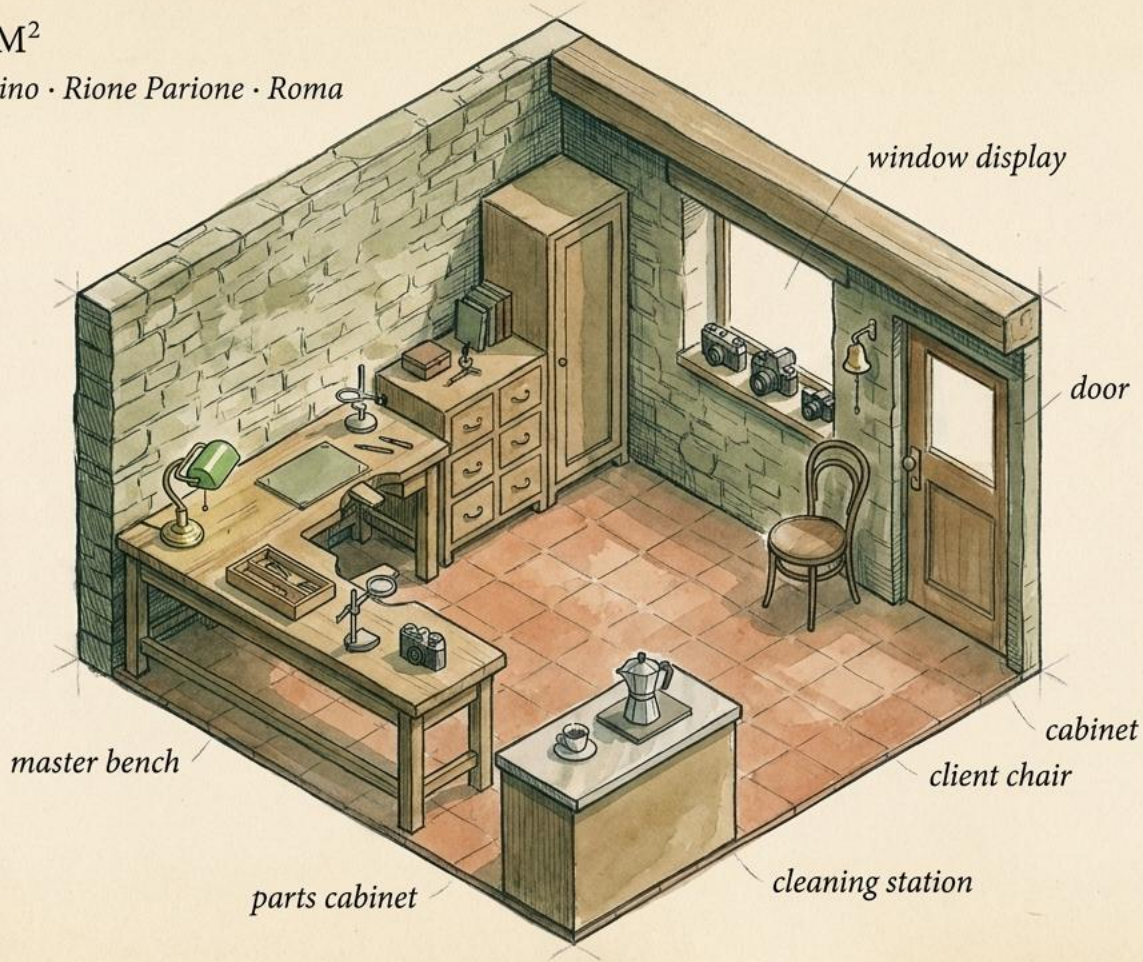
16 m² · 7 weeks · Via del Pellegrino

WHAT IT IS

22 · OTTICA 16 is a sixteen-square-metre workshop on Via del Pellegrino where analogue cameras are slowed, opened, listened to, and returned — Leica, Rolleiflex, Canonet, Contax, Nikon F. No rush, no upsell, no digital conversion. A single master, one apprentice, one bench of cleaned tools under brass lamplight. You leave your camera on Monday; on Friday you take it home quieter, smoother, aligned. Work is logged in Italian by hand, on linen paper, with the serial number and a small wax seal.
This is not a service for everyone — this is a service for those who would rather wait seven days than lose a sound.

PLAN · 16 M²

Via del Pellegrino · Rione Parione · Roma



FOOTPRINT · 4.0 × 4.0 M

BENCH LENGTH · 3.2 M

CEILING · 3.4 M

STATIONS ·
1 MASTER
1 APPRENTICE

STORAGE ·
6 DRAWERS
1 TALL CABINET

CAPACITY ·
12 REPAIRS / WEEK

22 · OTTICA 16

VIA DEL PELLEGRINO 12 - 00186 ROMA

arrival · Monday 10:42 · an Olympus OM-1 that stopped advancing

22 · OTTICA 16

INTERIOR · UNA BOTTEGA DI SEDICI METRI QUADRATI · STONE, BRASS, OAK, LINEN

materials

four surfaces that hold the workshop together

AGED BRASS — brass · ottone · 1930s lathe stock

WORN LEATHER — leather · cuoio tamponato a mano

WEATHERED OAK *bench top* — oak · rovere di Slavonia · *40 anni*

BONE-LINEN — linen · *lino · stamped*

RITUAL
the seven-minute listen

Before any screw is turned, the master listens.
Seven minutes, shutter fired at every speed, ear to the body.
The repair begins only when the sound tells him where it hurts.

instrumentarium

four tools the bench cannot forget

loupe · rangefinder body · screwdriver wrap · wax-stamped linen

the tools you actually need to repair analogue cameras

1. Swiss watchmaker's lathe (mini, aged brass and steel) €1 200

2. Brass jeweller's loupe 10× (patina, glass) €90

3. Magnetic parts tray set (three round trays, brass and green enamel) €40

4. Ultrasonic cleaner 2L €220

5. Torque screwdriver set €180

6. Shutter speed tester €380

7. Rangefinder calibration mirror €140

8. Bench vise €160

9. Leather tool wrap €110

10. Gooseneck brass desk lamp €140
aged patina, green shade

11. Digital microscope 40× €260
articulated arm, brass and black metal

12. Kodak-era tool cabinet €680
oak, 5 drawers, brass pulls

total bench · €3 600

Clean & lube (Leica M3/M6) — €180

Shutter recalibration — €220

Rangefinder alignment — €160

Full CLA (Rolleiflex TLR) — €340

Light-seal replacement — €60

Stuck-aperture fix (Canonet) — €110

Viewfinder prism cleaning — €90

Light-meter repair (Se-cell) — €120

Listen-only diagnosis — FREE

welcome-kit

how a camera comes home

linen wrap · report · oil · parts pouch · business card · thank-you note · serial tag

22 · OTTICA 16 · SIGNAGE

wayfinding · typography · wayfinding

facade plaque · ottone inciso

window hours · gold-leaf

serial tag · brass

business card · letterpress

typography · palette · pattern · seal

22 · OTTICA 16

riparazioni · ottica · meccanica · dal 2026

Via del Pellegrino 12 · Roma

Display: AGM22

Body: quiet mastery of mechanical optics

Captions: 22 · OTTICA 16

#1F2E28	#7A8B4F	#3A4F3A	#F0E4CF	#C7755B
deep forest	muted olive	moss	bone-linen	sun-faded terracotta

UNIT · ECONOMICS

how a sixteen-square-metre workshop pays for itself

€6 800

average monthly revenue · 52 repairs · 8 walk-ins

€2 800

average monthly OPEX · rent · utilities · oil · parts

€4 000

average monthly gross margin · 59%

22 months

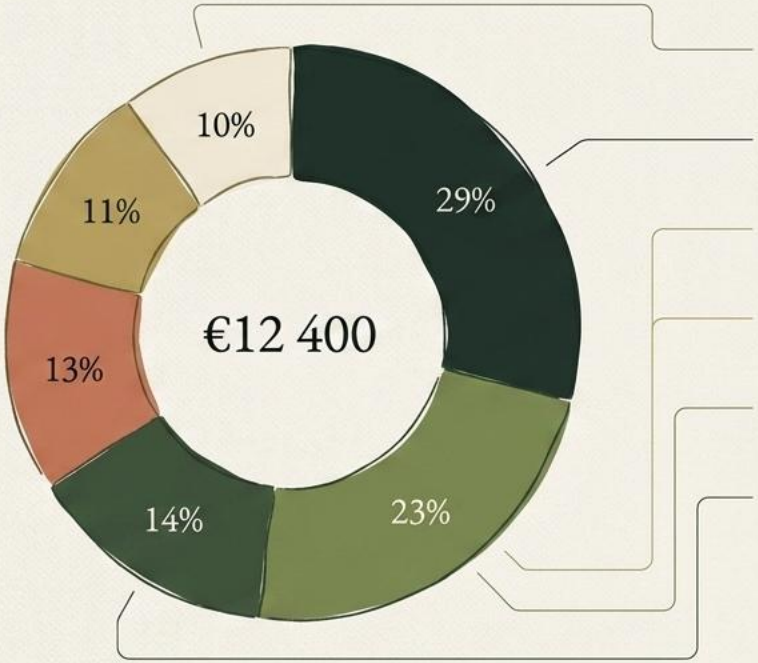
payback on €12 400 capex · conservative

OTTICA 16 is not a volume business. Twelve cameras a week is a comfortable rhythm; fifty-two a month is a full bench. The workshop breaks even at thirty repairs — everything after is the quiet wage of expertise.
No digital conversions. No upsell. Just the hand and the lamp.
Numbers are indicative, not guaranteed — a craft bench depends on the neighbourhood that finds it.

figures are illustrative indicative averages · Roma · 2026 prices

capex · €12 400

what it costs to open a 16 m² repair bench in Rome



€3 600 · bench tools + lathe + ultrasonic + microscope · 29%

€2 800 · stone + oak bench + tall cabinet + terracotta floor · 23%

€1 800 · signage + window gold leaf + letterpress cards + wax stamp · 14%

€1 600 · initial parts inventory (shutter curtains, seals, oils) · 13%

€1 400 · lighting (brass lamps × 4) + rewiring · 11%

€1 200 · security + alarm + legal licence · 10%

total · €12 400

figures are rounded averages · 2026 Rome prices · self-funded.

TIMELINE · 7 WEEKS

from keys to first camera on the bench

W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7
keys · stone walls scrubbed · rewiring starts	oak bench installed · parts cabinet built	terracotta floor laid · lighting rigged	tools unpacked · lathe + ultrasonic commissioned	signage crafted · window gold-leafed · cards printed	first pilot repairs (friends only) · insurance + licence filed	soft opening Saturday · first paying client Monday

Seven weeks is a conservative rhythm. Roman permits may stretch one, delivery of Swiss tools may stretch another. The master's first listen is unscheduled — it happens when the bench is quiet.

TEAM · 3 HANDS

who keeps the bench alive

GIULIO MARCHETTI

maestro · 62 · Roma

— seven-minute listen diagnosis
— calibrations · lathe · shutter curtains
— final sign-off & wax seal

working 6 days · €—— (owner)

LUCIA RIZZO

apprentice · 28 · Trastevere

— light-seal replacement · lens cleaning
— receiving, cataloguing, packaging
— workshop social + write-ups

5 days · €1 800 / mo

ANNA FORTE

front-of-shop · 50 · Prati
part-time · 3 days

— appointments, calls, espresso
— stock, orders, letters
— Italian & English

3 days · €700 / mo

total labour · €2 500 / mo · included in OPEX · grows to 4 hands from year two.

the Friday she took it home · via del Pellegrino · 14:12

who walks in

three portraits · three reasons

MATTIA SPINELLI
38 · architect · Trastevere

I bought my father's Leica M3 at an estate sale. It sat on my shelf for a decade because nobody in Milano would touch it. Giulio took one afternoon, listened, and told me exactly what it needed. I got it back in seven days.

— walks in for inheritance-camera restoration

SARA BIANCHI
42 · film director · Monteverde

I shoot on Arri, but my scout camera is a 1975 Rolleiflex. When the shutter started sticking, I thought I'd lost it forever. OTTICA 16 doesn't pretend — they tell you when something's beyond repair. Mine wasn't.

— walks in for working-camera CLA

HIROSHI TANAKA
56 · tourist · Osaka

Every time I'm in Rome I bring a Canonet that needs something. The master speaks little English, I speak less Italian. Somehow the camera camera always tells him what is wrong. This visit: light-seal replacement.

— walks in annually, pilgrim

each persona pays between €90 and €340 · average ticket · €210

CHANNELS · VOICE

how the workshop becomes known

WALK-IN WINDOW

The bench is visible from the street. On Saturdays the door stays open. The signage is in brass and never changes. The shop itself is the billboard.

cost · €0

LETTER TO PATRONS

Every client receives a hand-signed note three months after their repair, in Italian or English, on linen paper. It is a signal, not a sales letter.

cost · €0.80 per letter

INSTAGRAM — @ottica.16

Twice a week. A single photograph, a single caption in two languages. No reels, no trends, no offers. Italian film-camera collectors find us through each other.

cost · €0 · in-house

CONCIERGE PARTNERSHIPS

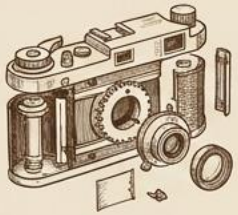
Quiet referrals from three Roman hotel concierges who know their guests ask for repairs. We reciprocate with espresso and a small thank-you plaque.

cost · revenue-share · 10%

no paid ads · no growth hacks · reputation compounds slowly

three risks · three answers

candour before opening



RISK · PARTS SCARCITY

Original shutter curtains and Selenium cells for 1950s – 1970s cameras are not in regular production. A week's delay can become a month if a part must be hand-wound from brass stock.

ANSWER · *keep a three-month standing inventory, cultivate a network of three parts-holders (Germany, Japan, Croatia), and always quote conservative delivery to the client.*

RISK · APPRENTICE TRANSITION

The maestro is 62. Without an apprentice who stays, the workshop's knowledge walks away.

ANSWER · *Lucia is under formal apprenticeship from year one with a 25% revenue-share path by year three; documentation of every repair in a shared logbook.*

RISK · ROMAN RENT PRESSURE

Via del Pellegrino sits in a tourist quarter. Rents rise 6–8% per annum, and short-term conversions tempt landlords.

ANSWER · *negotiated a 7-year lease with capped annual inflator at CPI + 2%; a back-up shortlist of three comparable spaces in Rione Monti and Testaccio.*

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craft businesses die of silence around risk · not risk itself

MANIFESTO

A camera is not a product.
A camera is the tool by which a person saw
something they wanted to keep.

When the camera stops, the seeing stops.

We are not a repair shop.
We are the people who make sure the seeing continues.

Sixteen square metres.
One master. One apprentice.
One bench under one brass lamp.
Seven days.
No rush · no upsell · no guarantees.
Only the honest hand and the patient ear.

If this is what you wanted,
Via del Pellegrino is waiting.

— *il maestro* · Giulio

THE PACKAGE

everything you need to open this workshop in your own city

BRANDBOOK · 80-page linen hardcover · English + Italian

P&L MODEL · spreadsheet + printed booklet · 3 scenarios

FLOORPLAN · axonometric + to-scale blueprint · AutoCAD source

EQUIPMENT BILL · 42 items · suppliers · 2026 euro prices

SERVICES MENU · 16 services · dual-language letterpress card

8-WEEK TIMELINE · fold-out gantt · milestone templates

DAY-ONE KIT · signage templates · wax-seal die · Instagram starter pack

Concept €49 · licence for one location · Exclusive €149 · licence retired from catalogue

claim this concept

22 · OTTICA 16

A 16 m² quiet-mastery workshop for analogue camera repair in Rome.

Concept · €49

full brandbook · P&L · floorplan · equipment · menu · timeline · Day-One Kit
non-exclusive licence · one location

Exclusive · €149

all of the above, plus:
concept retired from catalogue · renamed "22 · OTTICA 16 (yours)"
thirty-minute consultation with the curator